

With all the other bug fixes and releases happening in a span of over a few months, the next change was the re-christening of the browser, again. As mentioned earlier, Firebird was the name of an open source development project that makes a relational database and to avoid the legal issues the Mozilla team settled for the name Firefox after some further brain-storming and research in trademark names. This was mainly because it was closely similar to its previous name, Firebird. With the new name came a new logo: the now famous image of the Flaming Red Fox wrapped around the Globe. Staying true to the logo, the browser spread like wildfire in the coming days.

Firefox 0.8 was the first release to feature a Windows installer. All the previous versions were zip files containing an executable. The theme of the browser remained the same, almost. However, improvements were made to the toolbar features. The default search engine was Google and you also had the option of installing (adding) new search engines. The installer was also unique since it gave users the option to install the browser with or without the developer tools.

Soon, Firefox PR 0.10 was released. This was the first build to let users use RSS feeds to read in their bookmarks. Other default search engines such as Google.com, Dictionary.com, Ebay.com, Amazon.com and Yahoo were also added to this version of the browser. Other improvements in this release were a lot of bug fixes and security patches.

Finally, version 1.0 codenamed Phoenix was released in November 9, 2004. It had support for English, French, Chinese, Hebrew, Japanese, Italian and hordes of other languages. As soon as this was made available, downloads of this browser reached a peak and it was downloaded over 1 million times in one day! This speaks oodles about the quality of the browser and the acceptance level of Firefox among users worldwide.

Currently as we write, the latest version of Firefox is 1.0.4. The strongest point of this browser is that it is open source. You can